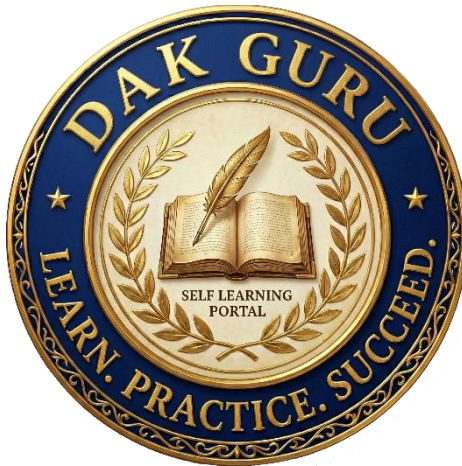




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THE POST OFFICE ACT, 2023 & THE POST OFFICE RULES, 2024

with an overview of the Post Office Regulations, 2024

Detailed Notes | Comparison with the 1898 Act | 55+ Practice MCQs

Verified against primary sources — updated August 2026

DISCLAIMER: *This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and the inclusion of the latest changes, amendments and updates to the relevant Act, Rules and Regulations, this document is intended as a study aid only. Readers are strongly advised to refer to the official Gazette of India and Department of Posts sources for authoritative information.*

About This Booklet

Coverage. This booklet covers the complete, in-force text of **The Post Office Act, 2023** (Act 43 of 2023, in force 18 June 2024) and **The Post Office Rules, 2024** (G.S.R. 767(E), in force 16 December 2024), section-by-section and rule-by-rule, with plain-language explanation, exam pointers and memory aids. It also gives a working overview of the third tier — **The Post Office Regulations, 2024** (S.O. 5440(E)) — which the Rules repeatedly refer to but which most notes omit entirely.

Why a fresh edition. The postal statute-book was completely rewritten between 2023 and 2024. A 125-year-old colonial Act was repealed and replaced by a lean 16-section framework, and the subordinate law was rebuilt in a new three-tier structure. Questions from this area now turn on the **new** numbering and the **new** architecture — old-syllabus notes based on the 1898 Act are actively misleading.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOKLET

- **Part 1 – Notes.** The framework first (three tiers + the 1898-vs-2023 comparison), then the Act, then the Rules, then a Regulations overview. Read the framework before the sections; it makes the rest fall into place.
- **Coloured boxes.** Quick Concept (navy) fixes the core idea; Exam Focus (saffron) flags what is actually asked; Memory Trick (green) gives a hook; Currency Alert (red) marks what is current as of Aug 2026; Compare 1898↔2023 (gold) marks the favourite comparison points.
- **Part 2 – Practice.** 55 MCQs with a verified answer key, plus a fresh set on the framework and Regulations that older question banks miss.
- **Part 3 – Currency Record.** Exactly what was verified, against which primary source, and on what date — so you can judge currency yourself.

Orientation: The New Postal Framework

1. From one colonial Act to a three-tier framework

For 125 years the postal law of India was contained in a single statute — the **Indian Post Office Act, 1898**. It was a long Act (originally around 74 sections) that mixed policy, procedure, tariffs and a full chapter of criminal offences. Over time it became outdated: post offices had grown into a delivery channel for banking, insurance, savings and dozens of citizen-centric services that a mail-only law of 1898 never contemplated.

The 2023 reform did two things. First, **Chapter X (all offences and penalties) of the 1898 Act was deleted in advance** by the Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Act, 2023. Then the whole 1898 Act was repealed and replaced by a deliberately minimal **Post Office Act, 2023** of just 16 sections, with the operating detail pushed down into Rules and Regulations. The result is a clean three-tier structure:

Tier	Instrument	Made by / under	Notified	In force
1. Act	The Post Office Act, 2023 (Act 43 of 2023) — 16 sections	Parliament	Assent 24.12.2023	18.06.2024
2. Rules	The Post Office Rules, 2024 — 19 rules	Central Govt. u/s 12	G.S.R. 767(E), 16.12.2024	16.12.2024
3. Regulations	The Post Office Regulations, 2024 — operational detail (products, tariffs, procedures)	Director General u/s 13 (with CG approval)	S.O. 5440(E), 16.12.2024	16.12.2024

QUICK CONCEPT — WHO MAKES WHAT

- **Rules** = made by the **Central Government** (Section 12). Broad framework matters.
- **Regulations** = made by the **Director General**, with **prior approval of the Central Government** (Section 13). Day-to-day operational detail — products, weights, tariffs, procedures.
- Both Rules and Regulations must be **laid before Parliament for 30 days** (Section 14).

MEMORY TRICK

“**A-R-R**” top to bottom: **Act** (Parliament) → **Rules** (Central Govt.) → **Regulations** (Director General). Authority narrows as you go down; detail increases as you go down.

2. Background — why the 1898 Act was repealed

- **Mail-only design.** The 1898 Act was built around letters and mail. Modern India Post runs banking (IPPB, POSB), insurance (PLI/RPLI), remittances, Aadhaar, passport seva and government DBT — none of which fit a mail-only statute.
- **Dead monopoly.** The Centre's exclusive privilege of conveying letters had become effectively meaningless after private couriers grew in the 1980s (couriers simply carried “documents” and “parcels”, not “letters”).
- **Decriminalisation drive.** Under the Government's ease-of-living / ease-of-doing-business policy, the Jan Vishwas Act 2023 had already stripped out the 1898 Act's offences, leaving a penal shell with nothing in it.
- **Simplicity.** A short enabling Act with detail in delegated legislation lets the Department update products and tariffs by regulation, without amending an Act of Parliament each time.

3. The Post Office Act, 2023 vs the Indian Post Office Act, 1898

This comparison is the single most heavily-examined part of the topic. Learn the **direction** of each change.

Point	Indian Post Office Act, 1898	Post Office Act, 2023
Length	Long (~74 sections) + a full offences chapter	Lean — only 16 sections, no offences
Exclusive privilege	Centre had monopoly over conveying letters	Only privilege retained is issuing postage stamps (Sec. 4)
Offences & penalties	Detailed penal chapter (theft, mis-appropriation, illegal opening, etc.)	None — all offences removed by Jan Vishwas Act 2023; Act creates no offence
Only civil consequence	Various	Unpaid charges recoverable as arrear of land revenue (Sec. 7)
Services	Essentially mail	Any service the Central Govt. prescribes — mail, banking, insurance, remittance, citizen-centric
Interception scope	Letters / postal articles	Any “item”; new ground of “emergency” added (Sec. 9)
Private couriers	Outside the Act	Monopoly gone; couriers operate freely (Act does not separately license them)
Structure	Single Act	Three tiers — Act + Rules + Regulations

EXAM FOCUS — THE FOUR “HEADLINE” CHANGES

- **No offences / no penalties** in the new Act (except the civil recovery in Sec. 7).
- **Only exclusive privilege = postage stamps** (Section 4) — the letter monopoly is gone.
- **Interception widened** to any “item”, with “emergency” added as a ground (Section 9).
- **16 sections only** — a favourite one-mark fact.

COMPARE 1898 ↔ 2023

If a question says “the Post Office has the exclusive privilege of conveying letters”, that is the **old** 1898 position and is now **wrong**. Under the 2023 Act the only exclusive privilege is **issuing postage stamps**.



Part 1A — The Post Office Act, 2023

Act No. 43 of 2023. An Act to consolidate and amend the law relating to the Post Office in India. Assented to by the President on **24 December 2023**; brought into force on **18 June 2024** vide notification **S.O. 2352(E)** dated 17 June 2024 (Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part II, Sec. 3(ii)). **16 sections in all.**

Section 1 — Short title, extent and commencement

(1) This Act may be called the Post Office Act, 2023.

(2) It shall come into force on such date as the Central Government may, by notification in the Official Gazette, appoint.

Explanation. The Act does not carry an “extent” sub-clause and its commencement was left to a later notification. The Central Government appointed **18 June 2024** as the date of commencement.

EXAM FOCUS

- Act No.: **43 of 2023**.
- Assent: **24.12.2023**; in force: **18.06.2024**.

Section 2 — Definitions

The Act itself defines **six terms** in Section 2, clauses (a) to (f). Two further definitions live **inside** Section 4 (*postage stamp, postal stationery*) and one inside Section 5 (*postcode*) — those are given in their own sections below. The six Section-2 definitions, reproduced exactly:

Clause	Definition (verbatim)
(a) Director General	means the Director General of Postal Services appointed by the Central Government and includes any officer authorised by the Central Government to perform the duties of the Director General.
(b) item	means an indivisible article which the Post Office accepts for providing a service.
(c) notification	means a notification published in the Official Gazette.
(d) Post Office	means the Department of Posts and includes every house, building, room, place or any other asset used by the Post Office for providing any service.
(e) prescribe	means prescribe by rules made under this Act, and the expression “prescribed” shall be construed accordingly.
(f) regulations	means the regulations made under this Act.

MEMORY TRICK – “PRESCRIBE” VS “REGULATIONS”

“Prescribe” always points to **Rules** (Central Government). “Regulations” point to the Director General. If a provision says “as may be *prescribed*”, look in the **Rules**; if it says “as specified in the *regulations*”, look in the **Regulations**.

EXAM FOCUS

- An “item” is **indivisible** — a favourite distractor is “any parcel below 10 kg”. Wrong.
- “Post Office” is not just a building — it is the **Department of Posts** plus every asset used to provide a service.

Section 3 — Services to be provided by Post Office

- (1) The Post Office shall provide such services as the Central Government may prescribe.
- (2) The Director General may make regulations — (a) in respect of activities necessary to provide the services referred to in sub-section (1); and (b) to fix charges for, and the terms and conditions of, those services.
- (3) Any service provided by the Post Office shall be subject to any other law for the time being in force.

Explanation. This is the engine of the whole scheme. The **menu** of services is fixed by the Central Government **by rules** (so services are “prescribed”); the **operation and charges** for those services are fixed by the Director General **by regulations**. Sub-section (3) keeps every service subject to other laws (e.g. RBI law for banking, IRDAI-adjacent norms for insurance).

EXAM FOCUS — SPLIT THE TWO ROLES

- **What** services exist → Central Government, by rules [3(1)].
- **How** they run and what they cost → Director General, by regulations [3(2)].

Section 4 — Exclusive privilege in respect of postage stamps

- (1) The Post Office shall have the exclusive privilege of issuing postage stamps.
- (2) The Director General may make regulations relating to the supply and sale of postage stamps and postal stationery.

(3) Definitions in this section —

postage stamp: any stamp provided by the Central Government, in any form — **physical or digital** — for denoting sums payable for a Post Office service, and includes stamps affixed, printed, embossed, embedded, impressed or otherwise indicated on an item.

postal stationery: stationery issued by the Post Office such as envelopes, letter cards and postcards bearing imprinted stamps or inscriptions indicating that the sum payable for a Post Office service has been prepaid.

COMPARE 1898 ↔ 2023 — THE HEADLINE CHANGE

The **only** exclusive privilege the Post Office now enjoys is **issuing postage stamps**. The 1898 Act's monopoly over *conveying letters* is **gone**. Note also that a postage stamp can now be **digital**, not just a gummed label.

EXAM FOCUS

- Exclusive privilege = **postage stamps** (not postcards, not money orders, not inland letter cards).
- Postal stationery = envelopes + letter cards + postcards with **imprinted** stamps → “All of the above”.

Section 5 — Addresses and postcodes

(1) The Central Government may prescribe standards for addressing on items, address identifiers and the usage of postcodes.

(2) **postcode** means a series of digits, letters or digital code (or a combination) used to identify a geographic area or location and to ease the sorting and delivery of items, and for other purposes.

QUICK CONCEPT

At the **Act** level the **Central Government** sets addressing/postcode **standards** [Sec. 5]. At the **Rules** level the **Director General** actually **manages, allocates and publishes** PIN codes [Rule 11]. Do not confuse the two — see the Rules note.

Section 6 — Power to give effect to arrangements with other countries

The Central Government may make rules to give effect to arrangements made with any foreign country or territory for services provided by the Post Office between India and that foreign country or territory.

Explanation. This is the treaty/UPU hook. International postal co-operation (Universal Postal Union, bilateral agreements) is given domestic effect through **rules** — see Rule 12, which spells this out.

Section 7 — Recovery of sums due

(1) Every person who avails a service provided by the Post Office shall be liable to pay the charges for that service.

(2) If a person refuses or neglects to pay, the amount shall be recoverable as if it were an arrear of land revenue due from him.

EXAM FOCUS — THE ONLY “CONSEQUENCE” IN THE ACT

Because the Act has **no offences**, Section 7 is the **only** adverse consequence it creates — and it is **civil**: unpaid charges are recovered **as an arrear of land revenue** (not as a fine, not as a civil-court debt).

Section 8 — Official mark to be evidence of certain facts

The Central Government may prescribe the conditions for denoting official marks on items to be used as prima facie evidence of the facts so denoted.

Explanation. An official Post Office mark (e.g. “refused”, “unclaimed”, “sum due”) can serve as **prima facie** — i.e. sufficient-until-rebutted — proof of the fact it records. The operative detail is in Rules 13 and 15.

Section 9 — Power to intercept, open or detain an item, or deliver to customs

(1) The Central Government may, by notification, empower any officer to cause any item in course of transmission to be intercepted, opened or detained, in the interest of —

- **security of the State,**
- **friendly relations with foreign states,**
- **public order,**
- **emergency,**
- **public safety,**
- or upon **contravention of this Act or any other law** for the time being in force.

(2) The Central Government may cause any such item to be disposed of in such manner as it deems appropriate.

(3) The Central Government may, by notification, empower any Post Office officer to deliver an item (received from within or beyond India) reckoned to contain anything liable to duty, or suspected to contain a prohibited item, to a customs authority or other specified authority, which shall then deal with it under the applicable law.

EXAM FOCUS — THE FIVE-PLUS-ONE GROUNDS

Learn the grounds as **S-F-P-E-P** + contravention: **Security of State, Friendly relations, Public order, Emergency, Public safety, plus contravention of law.** Interception is ordered **by the Central Government by notification** (not by a court, not by the DG).

COMPARE 1898 ↔ 2023

Two changes from the old law: interception now covers **any item** (not just letters), and “**emergency**” is added as a fresh ground. The Act itself lays down **no procedural safeguards** — those come from the **Rules** (Rule 16: competent-authority tiers, time-limits, a review committee).

Section 10 — Exemption from liability

(1) Notwithstanding any other law, the Post Office shall not incur any liability except such liability as may be prescribed with regard to a service.

(2) No officer of the Post Office shall incur any liability with regard to a service, unless the officer has acted fraudulently or wilfully caused loss, delay or mis-delivery.

EXAM FOCUS

- Post Office liability = **only as prescribed** (i.e. by rules/regulations) — otherwise none [10(1)].
- Officer is liable **only** if he acted **fraudulently** or **wilfully** caused loss/delay/mis-delivery [10(2)]. Mere negligence or accident → not liable.

Sections 11–13 — Delegation, Rules and Regulations

Sec.	Provision	Who	Key limit
11	Delegation of powers (other than rule-making) to the Director General	Central Govt., by notification	May delegate any of its powers — except the power to make rules
12	Power to make Rules	Central Government, by notification	For carrying out the purposes of the Act
13	Power to make Regulations	Director General	Only with prior approval of the Central Government, by notification

MEMORY TRICK

The one power the Central Government can **never** delegate to the DG is the **power to make rules** (Sec. 11). Rules stay with the CG; the DG only gets Regulations — and even those need **CG's prior approval** (Sec. 13).

Section 14 — Laying of rules and regulations in Parliament

Every rule or regulation shall be laid before each House of Parliament, while in session, for a total period of thirty days (in one or more successive sessions). If both Houses agree on a modification or that the rule/regulation should not be made, it takes effect only as modified, or not at all — without prejudice to anything already done under it.

EXAM FOCUS

Laying period = **30 days**, which may span **two** or more successive sessions. This applies to **both** rules and regulations.

Section 15 — Power to remove difficulties

(1) If any difficulty arises, the Central Government may, by order in the Official Gazette, make provisions (not inconsistent with the Act) to remove it — provided no such order is made after the expiry of two years from commencement.

(2) Every such order shall be laid before each House of Parliament.

EXAM FOCUS

Removal-of-difficulties window = **2 years** from commencement (i.e. up to 18.06.2026). A classic “which period?” MCQ.

Section 16 — Repeal and savings

(1) The Indian Post Office Act, 1898 (6 of 1898) is hereby repealed.

(2) Notwithstanding the repeal, all rules, notifications and orders made under the 1898 Act shall — in so far as they relate to matters provided for in this Act and are not inconsistent with it — be deemed to have been made under this Act and continue in force until superseded by rules, notifications or orders under this Act.

QUICK CONCEPT — WHY OLD MATERIAL STILL MATTERS

The savings clause [16(2)] is why a great deal of pre-2024 departmental material (old SB orders, manuals, forms) is **still valid** — it is “deemed” to have been made under the 2023 Act until expressly replaced. So the repeal did **not** wipe the slate clean overnight.



Part 1B — The Post Office Rules, 2024

G.S.R. 767(E), dated 16 December 2024. Made by the Central Government under **Section 12** of the Post Office Act, 2023, **in suppression of the Indian Post Office Rules, 1933**. In force **16.12.2024**. Signed by Vivek Kumar Daksh, Dy. Director General (F. No. 01-04/2024-PO). **19 rules in all.**

Rule 1 — Short title and commencement

These rules may be called the Post Office Rules, 2024; they come into force on the 16th day of December, 2024.

Rule 2 — Definitions

Rule 2(1) defines **eleven terms**, clauses (a) to (k). All eleven are reproduced below in the exact gazette order and wording. Rule 2(2) adds that words used here but **defined in the Act** carry the Act's meaning — so the Section-2 definitions (Director General, item, notification, Post Office, prescribe, regulations) also apply throughout the Rules.

Clause	Definition (verbatim)
(a) Act	means “the Post Office Act, 2023” (43 of 2023).
(b) Board	means the Postal Services Board specified in rule 5.
(c) Circle Head	means the Chief Postmaster General concerned or an officer exercising the powers of Chief Postmaster General in the circle.
(d) Divisional Head	means Director or Senior Superintendent or Chief Postmaster or Superintendent of Postal Division or Railway Mail Service (RMS) Division or Foreign Post, or an officer exercising those powers.
(e) mail offices	means the Post Offices or premises associated with handling, processing or transmission of items, used by the Department of Post.
(f) mail service	means all activities related to collection, handling, transmission, delivery, forwarding, returning and holding of items.
(g) postage	means the sum chargeable on mail service.
(h) Regional Director	means the Director concerned or an officer exercising the powers of Director in the region.
(i) Regional Head	means the Postmaster General concerned or an officer exercising the powers of Postmaster General in the region.
(j) universal postal service	means the provision of such postal services which are affordable and made available to all users, within and outside the country.
(k) value-added service	means add-on features on mail services.

MEMORY TRICK – THE OFFICER HIERARCHY

Circle Head = CPMG | Regional Head = PMG | Divisional Head = SSPO/SPO/Director. You will need this exact ladder for the interception tiers in Rule 16.

Rules 3–4 – Services and the Director General's authority

Rule 3 lists the services a Post Office may provide: (a) mail services (domestic/foreign); (b) value-added services; (c) universal postal service; (d) financial services — banking, Government Savings Bank, payment systems; (e) money remittances; (f) insurance (incl. life); (g) citizen-centric services as authorised; (h) addressing-identifier/postcode services; (i) State/Local Government services; (j) services through collaboration with public or private entities.

Rule 4 authorises the **Director General** to (a) introduce, modify or discontinue products, and (b) enter into collaborations with public or private entities for Rule-3 services.

EXAM FOCUS

- New products / modify / discontinue → **Director General** [Rule 4].
- The Rule-3 list is wide — banking, insurance, remittance and **collaboration with private entities** are all inside it.

Rules 5–6 – The Postal Services Board

Rule 5: The Postal Services Board is the apex-level policy-making body, with perpetual succession and a common seal, for any service provided by the Post Office under Rule 3.

Rule 6: The Central Government may, by notification in the Official Gazette, specify the composition of the Board and its powers, functions and duties.

EXAM FOCUS

- Apex policy-making body = **Postal Services Board** [Rule 5].
- Its composition is specified by the **Central Government** by notification [Rule 6] — the Rules themselves do not fix the membership.

Rules 7–8 – Postage stamps and the Philatelic Advisory Committee

Rule 7: Subject to Rule 8, the Central Government or the Director General shall issue definitive, commemorative and special postage stamps (or any other form of stamps/related material).

Rule 8: The Central Government may constitute a Philatelic Advisory Committee to advise it on commemorative and special postage stamps and allied matters.

MEMORY TRICK

Three kinds of stamp in Rule 7: **Definitive** (everyday), **Commemorative** (marks an event), **Special** issues. The **Philatelic Advisory Committee** advises on the commemorative/special ones.

Rules 9–10 — Modes of payment

Rule 9 — postage/other charges for mail services may be paid by: (a) cash; (b) digital mode; (c) postage stamp; (d) franking-machine impression; (e) any other mode specified in the regulations.

Rule 10 — modes of payment for **other** (non-mail) services are as specified in the regulations.

EXAM FOCUS

Valid modes under Rule 9 = cash, digital, postage stamp, franking impression → the answer to “which is a valid mode?” is **All of the above**.

Rule 11 — Addresses and postcodes

(1) The Director General shall, by regulations, (i) specify addressing standards on items and (ii) manage and allocate addressing identifiers and postcodes. (2) The Director General shall manage, allocate and publish Postcodes / PIN codes.

COMPARE WITH SECTION 5

Act Section 5 → **Central Government** sets the **standards**. Rule 11 → the **Director General** actually **manages, allocates and publishes** PIN codes. A common trap swaps these two.

Rule 12 — Arrangements with other countries

(1) The Central Government shall provide the Rule-3 services in furtherance of international postal co-operation. (2) Such co-operation shall be with other countries/territories, the Universal Postal Union (UPU), other postal unions or public/private entities, in conformity with the UPU Convention, its Manual and Regulations, and bilateral/multilateral agreements and applicable international law. (3) The Director General may issue regulations for these purposes.

EXAM FOCUS

International postal co-operation must conform to the **UPU Convention Manual and Regulations** [Rule 12(2)].

Rules 13–15 — Official marks and the sender

Rule 13 — Post Office marks are proof of certain facts denoted on an item (e.g. refused, rejected, unclaimed, undeliverable) and in any recovery proceeding for postage/sums due.

Rule 14 — the **sender** is deemed to be the person, or the address, from whom the item is purported to have come.

Rule 15 — the Director General may, by regulations, authorise officers to make an official mark denoting that a sum is due, that the mark proves the sum is due, and that the item was refused/rejected/unclaimed or undeliverable.

EXAM FOCUS

Under Rule 14 the **sender** = the person or address from whom the item is **purported to have come** — not necessarily the person who physically handed it in or wrote it.

Rule 16 — Interception, detention and opening of items

This is the operational counterpart to Section 9, and the most heavily tested rule. It sets up a **tiered competent-authority** scheme, **time-limits** and a **review committee**.

Who may order interception (the tiers)

Situation	Competent authority	Rule
Normal	A Member of the Board looking after Operations, or the Circle Head	16(1)
Unavoidable circumstances	An officer not below Regional Head / Regional Director	16(2)
Emergent (prior direction not feasible)	The Divisional Head — who must inform the 16(1)/16(2) authority within 3 working days, and get confirmation within 7 working days	16(3)

EXAM FOCUS — THE TIME-LIMITS (LEARN THESE COLD)

- Divisional Head must **inform** the competent authority within **3 working days** [16(3)].
- Confirmation must be received within **7 working days**; if not, the interception **ceases to operate** and cannot restart without prior approval [16(3) proviso].
- Directions stay in force up to **30 days** initially, extendable, but **never beyond 90 days**; on expiry the item is handed to the law-enforcement authority [16(11)].

Review committee, authorised officers and safeguards

- **Review committee [16(5)–(6)]:** Chairman = **Director General, Posts**; Members = **two** Members of the Board (other than the 16(1) Member). It must meet at least **once in three months**.
- **Authorised officers [16(7)]:** Officer in-charge of a Post Office, or Officer in-charge of a Mail Office — or any higher officer.
- **Opening safeguard [16(8)]:** No authorised officer may **open** an item except in the presence of the concerned **law-enforcement authority**.
- **Record-keeping [16(9)]:** Item category, tracking number, sender/addressee particulars, weight, postage, reason, dates and duration must all be recorded.
- **Reasons in writing [16(4)]; disposal per the Post Office Regulations, 2024 [16(10)];** interception does **not** exempt the sender from other action [16(12)]; and the rule applies **mutatis mutandis** to foreign items [16(13)].

MEMORY TRICK — “3-7-30-90”

3 working days to inform · 7 working days to confirm · 30 days initial force · 90 days absolute ceiling. Review committee = **DG + 2 Board Members**, meets **quarterly**.

Rules 17–19 — Customs delivery, other laws, and liability

Rule 17 — authorised officers may deliver a dutiable/suspected-prohibited item to a customs or other law-enforcement authority (notified under Section 9(3)) for action.

Rule 18 — Rule 16 does not bar interception required under any other law; such interception follows that other law's procedure.

Rule 19 — the Central Government shall provide compensation for loss/damage as specified in the regulations. Compensation **cannot exceed** the actual loss/damage and is **not** paid for prohibited items, for loss caused by the sender's fault/negligence, or for loss arising from **force majeure**.

EXAM FOCUS

Compensation is **NOT** paid if: the item was **prohibited**, the loss was due to the **sender's negligence**, or it arose from **force majeure** → “All of the above” [Rule 19(2)].

Part 1C — The Post Office Regulations, 2024 (Overview)

The Rules refer to “the regulations” at least a dozen times (payment modes, compensation, disposal of intercepted items, etc.). Those regulations are a real, separate instrument that most notes ignore. You should at least recognise them.

The Post Office Regulations, 2024 — S.O. 5440(E), dated 16 December 2024. Made by the Director General under **Section 13** of the Act (with the Central Government's prior approval), notified under Part II, Section 3, Sub-section (ii). In force **16.12.2024** — the same day as the Rules. They contain the **administrative and operational detail** of postal products and services.

What the Regulations did

- Rationalised the product basket — merged **Value Payable Post (VPP)** with **Cash on Delivery (COD)** and extended COD to retail customers.
- Revised limits — e.g. the **Money Order** ceiling raised to **₹10,000**, and retail remittances capped around **₹25,000** (per the Department's 16.12.2024 briefing).
- Set the operational conditions for post boxes / post bags, undelivered-article marking, registered newspapers, and re-use of previously-used stamps (the subject of PO Order PO-1/2024).

CURRENCY ALERT — THE REGULATIONS ARE A MOVING TARGET

Unlike the Act and the Rules (both stable), the **Regulations are amended frequently**. As of August 2026 the amendment series has reached the **Post Office (Fifth Amendment) Regulations, 2026 — S.O. 4053(E)**, dated 23.07.2026, in force **01.08.2026** — which revised Speed Post document definitions and tariffs. Earlier 2025 amendments (up to the Seventh Amendment, 2025) omitted “small packets” references and revised Schedule III tables.

Practical rule: for any *tariff, weight, dimension or product* figure, always check the latest amended Regulations / current SB & PO orders — those numbers are outside the scope of the Act and Rules and change often.

EXAM FOCUS — KEEP THE THREE TIERS STRAIGHT

- Structure / policy questions → **Act** (16 sections) or **Rules** (19 rules).
- Product / tariff / procedure questions → **Regulations** (and current departmental orders).
- If asked “disposal of an intercepted item is as specified in...?” → the **Post Office Regulations, 2024** [Rule 16(10)].

Core provision-based questions on the Act and the Rules. Answer key follows Set B.

- an "item" is:**
- a) 10 kg
 - b) Any letter or parcel
 - c) 100 kg
 - d) Any financial instrument
- Act includes:**
- a) The Department of Posts
 - b) The Department of Telecommunications
 - c) The Department of Information and Public Relations
 - d) Only places where the Post Office is situated

10. Who may prescribe standards for addressing on items and usage of postcodes (Sec. 5)?

- a) Director General
- b) Central Government
- c) Postal Services Board
- d) Universal Postal Union

11. Under Section 6, the Central Government may make rules to give effect to arrangements with:

- a) State Governments
- b) Private Courier Companies
- c) Foreign countries or territories
- d) Local Municipalities

12. Sums due for services provided by the Post Office are recoverable as:

- a) Civil debt
- b) Arrear of land revenue
- c) Fine imposed by a magistrate
- d) Income-tax arrears

13. Which section deals with the "Official mark to be evidence of certain facts denoted"?

- a) Section 6
- b) Section 7
- c) Section 8
- d) Section 9

14. Under Section 9(1), interception can be done in the interest of:

- a) Security of the State
- b) Public Order
- c) Emergency
- d) All of the above

15. Who empowers an officer to intercept items under Section 9(1)?

- a) Director General
- b) Central Government
- c) Circle Head
- d) District Magistrate

16. Items suspected to contain prohibited goods may be delivered to:

- a) The sender
- b) The police station
- c) Customs authority or other specified authority
- d) Dead Letter Office

17. The Post Office shall incur liability for services provided:

- a) In all cases of loss
- b) Only as prescribed
- c) Never
- d) Only for insured articles

18. An officer of the Post Office is liable for loss or delay if they acted:

- a) Negligently
- b) In good faith
- c) Fraudulently or wilfully
- d) Accidentally

19. Who can delegate powers (other than rule-making) to the Director General?

- a) President of India
- b) Parliament
- c) Central Government
- d) Postal Services Board

20. The power to make "Rules" under Section 12 lies with:

- a) Director General
- b) Postal Services Board
- c) Central Government
- d) Parliament

21. The power to make "Regulations" under Section 13 lies with:

- a) Central Government
- b) Director General (with prior approval of the Central Government)

- c) Postal Services Board

22. Rules and Regulations must be laid before Parliament for a total period of:

- a) 15 days b) 30 days
c) 60 days d) 90 days

23. Under Section 15, the power to remove difficulties is available for how long after commencement?

- a) 1 year b) 2 years
c) 3 years d) 5 years

24. The Post Office Act, 2023 repealed which Act?

- a) The Indian Post Office Act, 1933
b) The Indian Post Office Act, 1898
c) The Postal Services Act, 1952
d) The Department of Posts Act, 2000

25. According to Rule 1 of the Post Office Rules, 2024, they come into force on:

- a) 1st April 2024
b) 16th December 2024
c) 1st January 2025
d) Immediate effect

26. In the Rules, "Circle Head" refers to:

- a) Postmaster General
b) Chief Postmaster General
c) Director Postal Services
d) Divisional Superintendent

27. "Mail Office" is defined as premises associated with:

- a)** Selling stamps only **b)** Administrative work only
- c)** Handling, processing or transmission of items **d)** Staff quarters

28. "Postage" is defined in the Rules as:

- a) Cost of the envelope b) Sum chargeable on mail service
c) Tax on courier services d) Tip for the postman

29. "Universal Postal Service" implies services that are:

- a) Expensive and premium b) Affordable and available to all users
c) Available only in cities d) Free of cost

30. Who is authorised to introduce new products or modify existing ones under Rule 4?

- a) Central Government b) Postal Services Board
c) Director General d) Minister

31. The apex-level policy-making body for services under Rule 5 is:

- a) Ministry of Communications b) Postal Services Board
c) Director General's Office d) Philatelic Advisory Committee

32. Who advises the Government on commemorative stamps?

- a) Postal Services Board b) Philatelic Advisory Committee
c) Ministry of Culture d) Stamp Design Unit

33. Which is a valid mode of payment for postage under Rule 9?

- a) Cash
- b) Digital mode
- c) Franking machine impression
- d) All of the above

34. Who manages and allocates addressing identifiers and postcodes (Rule 11)?

- a) Central Government
- b) Director General
- c) Circle Head
- d) Nodal Officer

35. Who is deemed to be the sender of an item under Rule 14?

- a) The person who hands it over
- b) The person or address from whom the item is purported to have come
- c) The person paying the postage
- d) The person writing the letter

36. Who can order interception of items under Rule 16(1)?

- a) Any Postmaster
- b) Member of the Board (Operations) or Circle Head
- c) Assistant Superintendent
- d) Public Relation Inspector

37. In unavoidable circumstances, who can order interception under Rule 16(2)?

- a) Officer not below the rank of Regional Head / Regional Director
- b) Divisional Head
- c) Head Postmaster
- d) Inspector of Posts

38. In emergent cases, a Divisional Head ordering interception must inform the competent authority within:

- a) 24 hours
- b) 2 working days
- c) 3 working days
- d) 5 working days

39. Confirmation for an emergency interception by a Divisional Head must be received within:

- a) 3 days
- b) 7 working days
- c) 15 days
- d) 30 days

40. The Review Committee for interception consists of:

- a) DG Posts and 2 Board Members
- b) Secretary Posts and Minister
- c) 3 Board Members
- d) Circle Head and Regional Head

41. The Review Committee must meet at least:

- a) Once a month
- b) Once in two months
- c) Once in three months
- d) Once a year

42. Which officer is authorised to intercept items on the orders of the competent authority?

- a) Postman
- b) Officer in-charge of Post Office or Mail Office (or higher)
- c) Sorting Assistant
- d) Multi-Tasking Staff

43. An authorised officer must open an intercepted item only in the presence of:

- a) The sender
- b) The addressee
- c) Concerned law-enforcement authority
- d) Two independent witnesses

44. Directions for interception remain in force initially for a period not exceeding:

- a) 7 days
- b) 15 days
- c) 30 days
- d) 60 days

45. The total period of interception (including extensions) cannot exceed:

- a) 60 days
- b) 90 days
- c) 120 days
- d) 180 days

46. After expiry of the interception period (max 90 days), the item must be:

- a) Returned to sender
- b) Destroyed
- c) Handed over to concerned law-enforcement authority
- d) Delivered to addressee

47. Does interception exempt the sender from action if the item would have been delivered?

- a) Yes, fully exempted
- b) No, it does not exempt the sender
- c) Only if the item was valuable
- d) Only if the sender apologises

48. Compensation for loss or damage shall NOT be paid if:

- a) The item was prohibited
- b) Loss caused by negligence of sender
- c) Loss arising from force majeure
- d) All of the above

49. Who specifies the composition of the Postal Services Board?

- a) Director General
- b) Central Government
- c) Parliament
- d) Union Public Service Commission

50. Under Rule 12, international postal co-operation must conform to:

- a) United Nations Charter
- b) UPU Convention Manual and Regulations
- c) World Trade Organization
- d) International Monetary Fund

51. "Value-added service" means:

- a) Free services
- b) Add-on features on mail services
- c) Banking services only
- d) Discounted services

52. The Post Office Act, 2023 replaces an Act from which year?

- a) 1947
- b) 1898
- c) 1933
- d) 1854

53. Section 10(1) states the Post Office shall not incur liability except:

- a) As decided by the Court
- b) As prescribed with regard to a service
- c) If the sender is a government employee
- d) If the item is a parcel

54. Who acts as Chairman of the Review Committee under Rule 16(5)?

- a) Member (Operations)
- b) Secretary (Posts)
- c) Director General, Posts
- d) Minister of State

55. What happens if confirmation for emergency interception is not received within 7 days?

- a) Interception continues indefinitely
- b) Interception ceases to operate
- c) The officer is suspended
- d) The item is destroyed immediately

Set B — Framework, Comparison & Regulations (Q 56–73)

56. How many sections does the Post Office Act, 2023 contain?

- a) 12
- b) 16
- c) 19
- d) 24

57. By which notification was the Post Office Act, 2023 brought into force?

- a) G.S.R. 767(E)
- b) S.O. 2352(E) dated 17.06.2024
- c) S.O. 5440(E)
- d) S.O. 2353(E) dated 18.06.2024

58. All offences under the Indian Post Office Act, 1898 were removed by:

- a) The Post Office Act, 2023
- b) The Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Act, 2023
- c) The BNS, 2023
- d) The Post Office Rules, 2024

59. Under which section of the Act are the Post Office Rules, 2024 made?

- a) Section 3
- b) Section 12
- c) Section 13
- d) Section 15

60. The Post Office Regulations, 2024 were notified vide:

- a) G.S.R. 767(E)
- b) S.O. 2352(E)
- c) S.O. 5440(E)
- d) G.S.R. 5440(E)

61. The three-tier postal framework, top to bottom, is:

- a) Regulations → Rules → Act
- b) Act → Regulations → Rules
- c) Act → Rules → Regulations
- d) Rules → Act → Regulations

62. Under the 2023 Act, the Post Office's exclusive privilege is limited to:

- a) Conveying all letters
- b) Issuing postage stamps
- c) Money remittance
- d) Parcel delivery

63. Which is the only adverse consequence created by the Post Office Act, 2023 itself?

- a) Imprisonment up to 7 years
- b) A fine up to ₹50,000
- c) Recovery of unpaid charges as arrear of land revenue
- d) Cancellation of postal licence

64. The Post Office Rules, 2024 were made in suppression of:

- a) The Indian Post Office Rules, 1933
- b) The Indian Post Office Act, 1898
- c) The Post Office Regulations, 2024
- d) The GDS (C&E) Rules, 2020

65. A "postage stamp" under Section 4 may be:

- a) Only a gummed paper label
- b) Physical or digital
- c) Only an embossed impression
- d) Only a franking impression

66. Which body is described as having perpetual succession and a common seal?

- a) Philatelic Advisory Committee
- b) Postal Services Board
- c) Review Committee
- d) Circle Office

67. A new ground for interception added by the 2023 Act (absent in the pre-Jan-Vishwas 1898 framing) is:

- a) Public order
- b) Emergency
- c) Security of the State
- d) Friendly relations with foreign states

68. Who signed the Post Office Rules, 2024 notification?

- a) The Director General, Posts
- b) Vivek Kumar Daksh, Dy. Director General
- c) The Secretary (Posts)
- d) Ashwini Vaishnaw

69. Which layer of the framework is amended most frequently?

- a) The Act
- b) The Rules
- c) The Regulations
- d) None — all are frozen

70. As of August 2026, the latest amendment to the Post Office Regulations, 2024 is the:

- a) First Amendment, 2025
- b) Fifth Amendment, 2026
- c) Seventh Amendment, 2025
- d) Tenth Amendment, 2026

71. Disposal of an intercepted item is done in the manner specified in the:

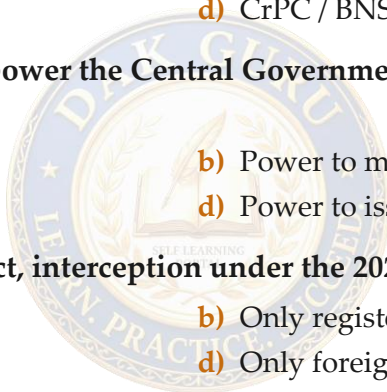
- a) Post Office Act, 2023
- b) Post Office Rules, 2024
- c) Post Office Regulations, 2024
- d) CrPC / BNSS

72. Under Section 11, the one power the Central Government may NOT delegate to the DG is:

- a) Power to intercept
- b) Power to make rules
- c) Power to fix charges
- d) Power to issue stamps

73. Compared with the 1898 Act, interception under the 2023 Act extends to:

- a) Only letters
- b) Only registered articles
- c) Any item
- d) Only foreign mail



Part 3 — Answer Key

Q	A	Q	A	Q	A	Q	A	Q	A
1	c	16	c	31	b	46	c	61	c
2	c	17	b	32	b	47	b	62	b
3	b	18	c	33	d	48	d	63	c
4	c	19	c	34	b	49	b	64	a
5	b	20	c	35	b	50	b	65	b
6	c	21	b	36	b	51	b	66	b
7	c	22	b	37	a	52	b	67	b
8	b	23	b	38	c	53	b	68	b
9	d	24	b	39	b	54	c	69	c
10	b	25	b	40	a	55	b	70	b
11	c	26	b	41	c	56	b	71	c
12	b	27	c	42	b	57	b	72	b
13	c	28	b	43	c	58	b	73	c
14	d	29	b	44	c	59	b		
15	b	30	c	45	b	60	c		

Part 4 — Currency & Verification Record

What was checked, against which primary source, and the position as of **August 2026**. This lets you judge currency for yourself and re-verify before the exam.

A. What changed from the previous edition of these notes

Item	Previous edition	Corrected / added
Commencement notification	S.O. 2353(E)	S.O. 2352(E) dated 17.06.2024 (date 18.06.2024 unchanged)
Section 1 heading	"Short title, extent, application and commencement" (the 1898 heading)	"Short title, extent and commencement" (the 2023 Act's own heading)
Regulations tier	Not covered	New Part 1C — Post Office Regulations, 2024 (S.O. 5440(E)) explained
1898 vs 2023 comparison	Absent	Added — no offences, letter-monopoly removed, 16 sections, wider interception
Jan Vishwas context	Absent	Added — offences removed by Act 18 of 2023 before repeal
Practice set	55 MCQs	55 verified + 18 new framework/Regulations MCQs

B. Currency status of each instrument

Instrument	Status (Aug 2026)	Verified against
Post Office Act, 2023	In force 18.06.2024. Unamended.	India Code consolidated Act "as on 06.10.2025"
Post Office Rules, 2024	In force 16.12.2024. Unamended.	Gazette G.S.R. 767(E); DoP F. No. 01-04/2024-PO
Post Office Regulations, 2024	In force 16.12.2024. Amended repeatedly — latest 5th Amdt 2026 (S.O. 4053(E), eff. 01.08.2026).	Gazette S.O. 5440(E) and subsequent amendment notifications
Indian Post Office Act, 1898	Repealed by Sec. 16, PO Act 2023. (Offences already omitted by Jan Vishwas Act 2023.)	Sec. 16; Jan Vishwas Act (18 of 2023)
Indian Post Office Rules, 1933	Superseded by the PO Rules, 2024.	Preamble to G.S.R. 767(E)

C. Points flagged for the reader to re-verify

- **Postal Services Board composition (Rule 6).** Rule 6 is enabling — the Central Government “may” notify the composition. Treat any specific membership list as requiring confirmation against the actual composition notification.
- **Section 9 interception officers.** The Rules notify the Officer-in-charge of a Post/Mail Office (or higher) as authorised officers [Rule 16(7)]; any separate Section 9 notification empowering officers should be read alongside.
- **Regulations figures.** Tariffs, weights, dimensions and product limits live in the Regulations and change often — verify against the latest amendment / current SB & PO orders, not against these notes.

D. Primary & authoritative sources used

- India Code — Post Office Act, 2023 (Act 43 of 2023), consolidated text as on 06.10.2025 [indiacode.nic.in].
- Gazette of India — G.S.R. 767(E), 16.12.2024 (Post Office Rules, 2024); S.O. 5440(E), 16.12.2024 (Post Office Regulations, 2024).
- Department of Posts — enactment communication on S.O. 2352(E)/commencement; F. No. 01-04/2024-PO.
- Gazette — Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Act, 2023 (Act 18 of 2023), which omitted the 1898 Act's offences.
- Gazette — Post Office (Fifth Amendment) Regulations, 2026, S.O. 4053(E), 23.07.2026; and 2025 amendment notifications.
- PRS Legislative Research — analysis of the Post Office Bill, 2023 (for the comparison points).

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